

Bachelor's Thesis E&OR

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Agenda

- 1 Introduction & Timeline
- 2 Writing your bachelor thesis

Writing your bachelor thesis

Your bachelor thesis

- is the final piece of work of your bachelor studies
- will demonstrate that you can apply the knowledge and skills that you have acquired to a specific research problem
- will show that you can present your ideas and results in different ways (presentation, poster, thesis)

Timeline

- 27.02: Publication of thesis topics
- 13.03: Deadline to submit thesis preferences

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- 06-08.05: Intermediate Presentations
- 24.06: Final poster presentations
- 26.06: Deadline to hand in final thesis

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- Mid July: Publication of thesis results

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- 27.02: Publication of thesis topics
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- 20.03: Publication of topic allocation
- 06-08.05: Intermediate Presentations
- 24.06: Final poster presentations
- 26.06: Deadline to hand in final thesis
- Mid July: Publication of thesis results
- 24.07: Deadline to hand in final thesis [resit]
- Mid August: Publication of results [resit]

Overview

- 1 Introduction & Timeline
- 2 Writing your bachelor thesis

Writing your bachelor thesis

Your thesis has the structure of an (academic) paper

- Introduction/Motivation: Research question
- Literature review
- Model and/or hypotheses
- (Theoretical) analysis and results
- Conclusion and discussion

Writing your bachelor thesis

Research question

Writing your bachelor thesis

Research question

- precise formulation and no easy answer
- practical and/or theoretical relevance
- not too narrow and not too broad

Writing your bachelor thesis

Literature Review

Writing your bachelor thesis

Literature Review

- puts the thesis work into context
- not just a summary of each article - be critical and establish the big picture needed for your thesis
- should be structured (theoretical/methodological work vs. experimental work, broad results vs. problem specific results)
- **Tip:** use Google scholar to find references

Writing your bachelor thesis

Model and/or hypotheses

Writing your bachelor thesis

Model and/or hypotheses

- describe the main models or methods that you use
- describe the data that is used (input format, parameters, etc.)
- clearly explain notation, meaning of variables, etc.
- describe the algorithms/tests/formulas that are used
- (if applicable): setup of computational experiments

Writing your bachelor thesis

(Theoretical) analysis and results

Writing your bachelor thesis

(Theoretical) analysis and results

- detailed description of the outcomes (hypotheses testing, objective values, other performance criteria, etc.)
- explanation of the influence of parameters (sensitivity analysis)
- discussion of results: *global citizenship*

Writing your bachelor thesis

Conclusion

Writing your bachelor thesis

Conclusion

- stand-alone piece
- theoretical contribution
- managerial/societal implications and recommendations
- limitations
- suggestions for further research

Writing your bachelor thesis

Use of AI

Writing your bachelor thesis

Use of AI

- You may use GenAI as a search engine, "sparring partner" or translator
- You may not submit any computer-generated text without appropriate citation
- Be critical and verify GenAI content

Writing your bachelor thesis

Final remarks

Writing your bachelor thesis

Final remarks

- Look at other good examples
 - Best theses 2017: <https://openjournals.maastrichtuniversity.nl/Marble/issue/view/48>
 - Best theses 2018: <https://openjournals.maastrichtuniversity.nl/Marble/issue/view/61>
- Discuss with your supervisor which aspects are most relevant for the topic
- Do include figures/tables that illustrate the problem and highlight the main results
- There is no minimum/maximum length for the thesis (quality is preferred over quantity)
- Using $\text{\LaTeX}$ is preferred (a template will be provided)
- Read the rubrics used for grading

Intermediate Thesis Topic Presentation

- Present your research topic: problem, motivation and examples.
- Present the methods and initial ideas and results.
- Plan for a 15 minute presentation plus 5 minutes for discussion and questions.
- Schedule will be announced ca. 2 weeks in advance

Final Poster Presentation

- Present your research topic and the main results of your bachelor thesis.
- Summarize your findings and explain your research to the audience.
- Schedule will be announced ca. 2 weeks in advance

Assessment

Your final grade will be composed of four partial grades:

- Intermediate Thesis Presentation (10%)
- Final Poster Presentation (10%)
- Thesis grade supervisor (40%)
- Thesis grade second assessor (40%)

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Each component needs to have a grade of 5.5 or higher, otherwise you have to do a resit for that component.

Assessment

Rubrics for the Bachelor Thesis Presentation Econometrics & Operations Research		
Category	Weight	Description
Opening & Motivation	20%	• The opening of the presentation creatively catches the interest of the audience. • The problem statement/ thesis /purpose is explicitly and clearly formulated in the opening. • The problem statement/ thesis /purpose of the presentation is explicitly motivated through a gap in research and/or a specific problem in practice.
Content	40%	• Relevant ideas, findings, concepts, and frameworks are clearly and accurately explained throughout. • Materials are effectively presented through appropriate and relevant examples and additional materials in an accurate manner linking explicitly to the required materials. • Scientific reasoning is demonstrated through highlighting relationships and common ideas. • Questions from the class are answered clearly and accurately, demonstrating full mastery of the material.
Structure	20%	• The structure of the presentation is explicitly clarified. The audience's pre-existing knowledge is effectively taken into account. • There is a clear distinction between introduction, body, and conclusion of the presentation which enhances understanding. • Conclusions and insights presented are original and accurate, following logically from the content of the presentation. • The presentation is well-organised in terms of time, internal summaries, and the use of transitions.
Form & Delivery	20%	• The student creates a constructive learning atmosphere by proactively inviting discussion and providing an opportunity to ask questions. • The student speaks clearly with an appropriate tone of voice, maintaining eye contact with the audience without reading from slides or notes. • The presentation's mix of media and visual aids are effectively used and add clarity and impact throughout.

Assessment

Rubrics for the Bachelor Thesis Econometrics & Operations Research		
Category	100%	Description
Research Question, Motivation & Literature (20%)	20%	- The research question of the paper is accurate and clearly and explicitly stated. - The research question is clearly motivated using relevant existing research, reports, and/or (practical) examples. - Clear, complete and coherent overview of relevant theory and associated literature.
Methods & Analysis (40%)	40%	- The methods and techniques used are explicitly described, suit the research question and hypotheses, and the choice is motivated in relation to the research question. - Data collection, sampling strategy, and measurements are clearly described and are appropriate for the research question. - All applied methods suit the data and hypotheses, are adequately executed and their results are presented clearly.
Conclusions & Discussion (20%)	20%	- The results are discussed in detail and conclusions are explicitly stated and logically follow from the body of the paper. - Implications for practice/research are made explicit, adequate, actionable, and follow logically from the body of the paper. - Limitations are explicitly stated, considering both research approach and results in a constructive manner. - Concrete suggestions for further research are made.
Layout & Form (10%)	10%	- Writing technique and structure are clear and easy to follow throughout. - Paragraphs clearly communicate core arguments that consistently and logically follow from each other. - Style and tone are appropriate to academic writing. - Tables and figures enhance the clarity of research, are accurate, relevant, and clearly readable. - Paper contains very few/no grammatical, punctuation, and spelling errors. - Referencing is present, consistent and accurate throughout.
Thesis writing process (10%)	10%	- Student is highly engaged, makes and sticks to agreements and deadlines, seeks feedback regularly. - Student plans and performs research and writing tasks independently. - Students shows substantial growth in the aforementioned competences.

Some final remarks

- Watch the announcements in Canvas
- Respect the deadlines
- Stay in touch with your supervisor
- Read “*What I’ve learned*” by Wout de Vos.

Enjoy your research!